

■ Music Career Simulator

Development Reports

Internal changelog & feature specification · April 2025

v1.1

Health & Fatigue Fixes

9 April · 11:08 PM

Song Quality Behaviour

- Quality depletion begins only after fatigue exceeds **75%** — quality never reaches 0 until fatigue hits 100%.
- Once fatigue crosses 100%, quality slowly decays to 0 over time rather than dropping instantly.

Starting Values

- Chosen genre starts at **60**; all other genres default to **30**.
- Chosen skill starts at **60**; all other skills default to **25**.

Song Creation Quality Range

- With all factors (fatigue, health, skills, genre) producing a base score x , the range is always $(x - 2.5, x)$.
- While $\text{max quality} \leq 5$: score is drawn uniformly at random within that range.
- Once max quality exceeds 5, probability distribution becomes:
 - 20% chance $\rightarrow (x - 2.5, x - 2)$ — shitty track territory
 - 60% chance $\rightarrow (x - 2, x - 1)$ — average output
 - 10% chance $\rightarrow (x - 1, x - 0.5)$ — solid track
 - 10% chance $\rightarrow (x - 0.5, x)$ — peak quality

→ Ensures realism: even skilled artists occasionally produce below-average work.

Health Depletion

- Health depletion has been **reduced** — previous rate was too aggressive.

Fatigue & Skill Progression

- Skill additions increase fatigue cost as skill value rises. Threshold to trigger a skill gain in the **90–100** range requires the artist to be below **20% fatigue**.
- Extrapolated fatigue requirements across all skill ranges (proportional scaling from the 90–100 anchor):
 - 0–30 range $\rightarrow$ no fatigue restriction
 - 30–50 range $\rightarrow$ below 70% fatigue
 - 50–70 range $\rightarrow$ below 55% fatigue
 - 70–80 range $\rightarrow$ below 40% fatigue
 - 80–90 range $\rightarrow$ below 30% fatigue
 - 90–100 range $\rightarrow$ below 20% fatigue

Fatigue Recovery & Other Adjustments

- Fatigue recovery speed increased — artists should be able to bounce back more easily.
- Active course enrolment adds an extra **+15% fatigue** per week for the full **12-week** duration.
- Song creation now causes **less fatigue** than before.

Live Module — Sentence Pool Expansion

- All live-module sentence pools have been expanded with additional varied sentences.
- Long sentences are no longer repeated cyclically.
- Comments per cycle increased from ~10 to **15–20**.
- Repeated live sessions with low-viewer counts will reflect reduced comment diversity accordingly.

v1.2

Money & Popularity System

10 April · 4:22 PM

Popularity Meter

- Introduced a **Popularity** meter that starts at a minimal value and grows as the artist releases songs and goes live.
- New modules: **Management** and **PR**.
- Going live grants a **+5% base popularity** boost per session.

Currency & Side Hustle Jobs

- Currency is denominated in **USD (\$)**.
- Side hustle jobs introduced — examples below (names changed to avoid direct branding):
 - Fast-food crew member — **\$20 / week**, low fatigue cost
 - Additional jobs scale: more pay = more fatigue per week
- Genre courses now have an **in-game monetary cost** attached.

Media Management & PR Contracts

- Artists can sign contracts with one of **5 management companies**. Contract durations: monthly, 6-month, or yearly.
- Base price is negotiable around each company's listed rate.

Company	Contract Cost	Popularity Boost	Tier
Amplify Collective	\$1,000 / year	10 – 20%	Entry
The Narrative Arc	\$3,000 / year	20 – 25%	Standard
Momentum Media	\$10,000 / year	40%	Professional
Catalyst Comms	\$40,000 / year	60%	Elite
Verve Public Relations	\$100,000 / year	75%	Prestige

→ Management provides a weekly base popularity floor. Going live stacks an additional +5% on top of this.

Song Releases & Popularity

- Releasing a song provides an instant **+5% base popularity** boost in that week.
- In the following week, the released song contributes popularity proportional to its quality rating (e.g. a 10/10 adds 10%, a 5/10 adds 5%).
- Releasing an **album** grants a one-time **+15% popularity** boost in the release week only.

Stream Count & Song Quality

- Streams are driven by both **popularity (70%)** and **song quality (30%)**.
- A low-quality song on high popularity will still underperform; a high-quality song on low popularity will still do respectably.
- New module: **Shawtify Streams** — displays stream counts for all released songs.

Stream Earnings Formula

- Base rate: **\$0.01 per stream**. Milestone bonuses stack as follows:

Milestone	Bonus Earnings	Running Total
Base (per stream)	\$0.01 / stream	—
Every 10k streams	+\$10	Cumulative
Every 100k streams	+\$500	Cumulative
1M streams	+\$3,000	~\$19,000 total

→ Example: 1M streams = $(1M \times \$0.01) + \$3,000 + (100 \times \$10) + (10 \times \$500) = \$19,000$

- If signed to management, the management company deducts a negotiated **revenue-share** % from weekly stream earnings.
- Weekly earnings summary is displayed after each simulation turn, including the management cut breakdown.

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Job & Popularity Fixes

10 April · 5:27 PM

Side Hustle Job Rework

- Jobs now lock the artist into a **12-week commitment** — you cannot switch or stack jobs during an active contract.
- Pay is disbursed **once per week**; the weekly-choice-and-multi-activation exploit has been removed.
- Fatigue cost per job has been increased across the board to better reflect the workload.

Management Base Popularity — Corrected Behaviour

- Base popularity from a management contract is now a **fixed weekly value** — it does not stack or accumulate over time.
- Example: if a company provides 20% popularity, the artist sits at 20% from that source every week of the contract.
- When the contract expires, base popularity **gradually fades** to 0 over several weeks rather than cutting off instantly.
- Weekly base popularity varies within the company's stated range for realism (e.g. 17.5% one week, 21% the next).

Song-Driven Weekly Popularity Gains

- Each song's stream count this week contributes popularity according to the table below. Each tier has an individual cap, and total song-popularity gain is capped at **20% per week**.

Stream Threshold	Popularity Gain	Weekly Cap
1,000+	+0.5%	2%
10,000+	+1%	4%

100,000+	+3%	8%
1,000,000+	+5%	10%
Total song popularity cap	20% / week	—

Worked Example

Song	Streams This Week	Popularity Gained
Song 1	3,000	+0.5%
Song 2	15,000	+1.0%
Song 3	130,000	+3.0%
Song 4	7,000,000	+5.0%
Song 5	3,000,000	+5.0%
Song 6	14,000,000	+0.0% (cap reached)
Total	—	14.5% (below 20% cap)

→ Total song popularity gain = 14.5%. Had it exceeded 20%, it would be capped at 20%.